77 **'Well, Man Singh, where were you when God was distributing beauty in heaven?':** Rajiva Nain Prasad, *Raja Man Singh of Amber*, Calcutta: World Press, 1966, p. 20.

78 **Harkha Bai would require; dhai maas (wet nurses), dholans (female drummers):** Joshi, *Polygamy and Purdah*, p. 115.

79 **'but however much left and right I looked':** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 30.

79 **'his head was bare and he was wearing a lungi':** Ibid., p. 31.

79 **'It is hard to exaggerate how accessible he makes himself ':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 197.

79 **'a fine-looking broad-shouldered man':** Father Pierre du Jarric, S. J., *Akbar and the Jesuits: An Account of the Jesuit Missions to the Court of Akbar*, Plymouth: W. M. Brendon and Son Ltd, 1926, Oxfordshire: Routledge UK, 2014, p. 214.

80 **'the royal revenues, which were in the hands of embezzlers':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 277.

80 **'Son of a bitch!' he cursed Adham Khan:** H. Elliot, *History of India*, p. 27.

81 **'Adham killed our Ataka':** Ibid., p. 110–11.

82 **'[Akbar] had introduced a whole host of the daughters of the eminent Hindu rajas:** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 312.

82 **'Formerly I persecuted men into conformity':** Jarrett (trans.), 'Happy Sayings', *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 3, p. 181.

82 **'making captive the women, children and kinsmen':** Irfan Habib, 'Akbar and Social Inequities', *Proceedings of the IHC*, Vol. 53, 1992, p. 301.

82 **some two lakh persons were captured every year:** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*, p. 139.

82 **'killing, imprisoning and whipping':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 247.

83 **'however obvious the error of some people is':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 268.

84 **'On the completion of my twentieth year':** Jarrett (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 3, p. 386.

84 **'The emperor from his youth up had shown a special predilection':** C. M. Naim, 'Popular Jokes and Political History: The Case of Akbar, Birbal and Mulla Do-Piyaza', *Economic and Political Weekly*, Vol. 30, No. 24, 17 June 1995, p. 1458.

85 **Tansen, who would later have a remarkably lifelike portrait made of himself:** A portrait of 'Tansen of Gwalior' (1585–90), (11.8 x 6.7cm) at the National Museum, New Delhi.

85 **'a great terror fell upon the city':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 50.

85 **a young man named Falud, a freed slave:** Thackston (trans.), *History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 623.

86 **'Alas that in the first flush of youth':** Jarrett (trans.), 'Happy Sayings', *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 3.

86 **'placed a real burden on the poorest taxpayers':** John F. Richards, *The New Cambridge History of India: The Mughal Empire*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1995, p. 39.

86 **'the disapproval of statesmen' and 'much chatter on the part of the ignorant':** Satish Chandra, 'Jizyah and the State in India during the 17th Century', *Journal of the Economic and Social History of the Orient*, Vol. 12, No. 3, September 1969, p. 331.

87 **men professed their undying loyalty to Akbar:** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 553.

87 **'himself and to others':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 529.

87 **'experienced spies and traders':** Ibid.

88 **'at every 500 paces small pieces of stones are fixed':** Eraly, *The Last Spring: Life in India's Golden Age*, Part 2, New Delhi: Penguin Books, 1997, 2015 (repr.), p. 230.

88 **That he would keep a close watch on every one who came in:** Ibid., p. 233.